

THOMAS KABALIN

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PROFILE

Third-year Bachelor of Business Science (Computer Science) student at UCT, currently ranked first across the Computer Science cohort, combining strong technical and analytical ability with a commercial mindset. Backend experience at a Cape Town fintech building an investment platform, alongside a national role as a moderator and problem-setter for South Africa's Computer Olympiads. Drawn to the intersection of technology and business, and to using AI as a practical tool to build faster and automate manual processes.

EDUCATION

2024 - Present	Bachelor of Business Science, specialising in Computer Science <i>University of Cape Town</i> · GPA: 88.13 (Y1) · 85.68 (Y2) Vice-Chancellor's Scholarship (top 10 applicants from Western Cape) · Bain & Company Award (3rd, First-Year BBusSc) · BSG Prize (Best 2nd-Year CS) · Class Medals, ranked 1st in cohort: CSC1016S (Object-Oriented Programming, ~800 students), STA2020F (Applied Statistics, ~520 students), CSC2002S (Computer Science 2B, ~430 students) · Dean's Merit List 2024 & 2025
2018 - 2023	National Senior Certificate <i>Cannons Creek Independent High School</i> · Aggregate: 96.3% Dux Scholar · 8 Distinctions (three at 99%, all above 90%) · Silver Medal, SA Computer Applications Olympiad (top 3 of ~18,300) · Top 40 in the Western Cape (NSC) · Principal's Honour Award (character, loyalty & leadership) · PwC Award (Maths & Accounting) · Hoffman Trophy (Maths & Science)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Jan 2026 - Present	Junior Software Engineer <i>Fynbos Technologies</i> Build and ship backend features for a PHP (Laravel) fintech investment platform. Built from scratch a bank reconciliation system that auto-matches ~81% of transactions (replacing manual spreadsheet matching previously done by senior staff), and a direct-to-bank withdrawal feature that removes a manual step for customers. Apply emerging techniques in prompt, context, and memory engineering to orchestrate and critically review AI-generated code throughout.
Jan 2021 - Present	Entrepreneur <i>Digital Study Materials Business</i> Market and sell digital study notes to high school and university students, with a peak annual profit of R16 000 (2024). Designed and built an automated sales and fulfilment pipeline (Google Forms, Sheets, Apps Script) with automated buyer notifications and branded fulfilment emails, removing manual handling from each sale.
Jan 2025 & 2026	Data Entry Assistant (Seasonal) <i>Cannons Creek Independent School</i> Supported the executive head with student data administration (EdAdmin, CEMIS) and calendar management.

LEADERSHIP

2026 - Present	External Moderator (Volunteer) <i>SA Applications Olympiad and SA Talent Search</i> Serve as one of two national external moderators for competitions reaching over 50,000 participants annually, reviewing papers, identifying errors, and recommending improvements.
2024 - Present	Scientific Committee Member (Volunteer) <i>SA Programming Olympiad</i> Design and review algorithmic problems for South Africa's national programming contest, whose winners represent the country at the International Olympiad in Informatics, developing and inspiring the next generation of computer scientists.
2021 - 2022	Head of Sound, Lighting & AV Team <i>Cannons Creek Independent High School</i> Oversaw ~150 school events, as well as the training and management of the student technical team. During COVID-19, deployed a live-streaming system for valedictory and prize-giving, enabling parents worldwide to attend remotely at no additional cost to the school, and developed an automated booking system to streamline event scheduling and coordination.

FURTHER ROLES

- **Prefect**, Cannons Creek Independent High School (2023)
 - **Treasurer**, Matric Dance Committee (2022)
- **Chairperson**, Photographic Society (2021-2022)
 - **Head**, Pupil Marketing Team (2020-2021)

SKILLS & ABILITIES

Languages	Java, Python, PHP (Laravel), and C# (with working knowledge of SQL, HTML, CSS, and R)
Tools	JetBrains IDEs, VS Code, Visual Studio, RStudio, Git & GitHub, Linear
Environments	Linux (Ubuntu, Omarchy), Windows, WSL, VMware Workstation
AI-Driven Development	Prompt and context engineering; evaluating and integrating AI-generated code in production
Problem Solving	Structured and algorithmic thinking, from designing Olympiad problems to debugging complex real-world systems
Quantitative & Analytical	Grounding across CS, Statistics, and Mathematics; data analysis and statistical modelling in Python and R
Business & Entrepreneurship	Practical experience in sales, marketing, and independent business operations

CERTIFICATIONS & ONLINE COURSES

Machine Learning (Google) · Data Science (Cambridge International Qualifications) · FICA & Anti-Money Laundering (Masthead)

HOBBIES

Multi-Day Backpacking · SCUBA Diving · Trail Running · Home Lab (Self-Hosting) · Photography